recouped from the emitters of these emissions. This formed the starting point for a globally coordinated policy action and the need for an international climate change negotiating regime. UNFCCC, set up in 1992, although global in scope, differentiates the commitments/responsibilities of Parties on the basis of historic responsibilities, economic structures, and on the basis of the principle of 'equity' and CBDR which is at the core of the climate change debate.

The largest share of historical and current global emissions of GHGs has originated in developed countries. Scientists attribute the global problem of climate change not to the current of GHG emissions but to the stock of historical GHG emissions. Most of the countries, particularly the industrialised countries, having large current emissions are also the largest historic emitters and the principal contributors to climate change. The Convention therefore lays down legally binding commitments for the developed countries, taking into account their historical responsibilities and also squarely puts the responsibilities on developed countries for providing financial resources, including for the transfer of technology, needed by the developing countries. The Convention also acknowledges that climate change actions taken by developing countries are contingent on the resources made available to them.

A volatile mix of erratic weather, natural disasters, and enormous pressure on the availability of clean air, water, and energy together with the problems of poverty and hunger continues to be of great concern for policymakers particularly in the developing countries. There was building of the forward momentum both globally and domestically with three high-profile events in the global arena in 2012 and launch of the Twelfth Five Year Plan at home. The Earth Summit in Rio also popularly known as Rio + 20 celebrated its 20th anniversary, next the 11th session of the Conference of Parties (**COP 11**) to the Convention on Bio Diversity (CBD), hosted by India in Hyderabad, and finally the year closed with the 18th session of the COP to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in **Doha** in December. These international collaborations came out with balanced packages though short on ambition but proceeding on efforts. At home, we launched the Twelfth Five Year Plan whose explicit theme was a